stackArmor is committed to helping our customers transition to the new VDR/VER processes outline by BOD 26-04 and FedRAMP CR26. As we prepare for implementation of the new TSW 4.0 to transition our customer from legacy Continuous Monitoring to this fast paced, active threat monitoring we have provided guidance (VDR Testing Summary and skills) for your engineers to begin classifying and labeling your FedRAMP assets as any vulnerability identified in the new process that is not properly labelled will automatically be classified as a N4 or N5 finding resulting in potentially unnecessary stress in the remediation process.

It is important to note that labelling can be completed manually or with the assistance of an AI agent, no matter your approach it has to get done before stackArmor's solution will help your organization meet this new challenge.

For those of us that are not engineers, the below will provide you with a high-level understanding of what needs to be accomplished to prepare your system for VDR.

Step 1: Try the Online Calculator (Optional)

We built a website called the PAIN Playground with simple buttons and sliders. Anyone (technical or non-technical) can click around to see: "If an app is High Importance and on the public internet, how fast do we have to fix a bug vs. if it's Low Importance and internal-only?"

Step 2: Install the Practice Scanner (Container based systems only)

If your system is built on Kubernetes, Cloud Run, ECS, or Docker Swarm, an engineer installs the free, open-source scanner (Trivy + stackArmor's vdr add-on) on their laptop. It only needs read-only access to your environment.

If your environment is not container based, or can't be scanned by Trivy please reach out to your stackArmor team to discuss this in more detail.

Step 3: Let Our AI Skills Help

Labeling hundreds of apps or resources by hand is tedious. We have built an AI helper (vdr-agent-skills) that safely looks at the names of your apps (it never looks at passwords or secrets and never changes anything) and automatically writes a first draft of your Master Floor Directory (vdr-fedramp.yaml). You can check out a sample output of the labels here.

Why this step is super important: If you run the scanner without this directory, the scanner has to assume every single room is a top-secret bank vault (High / High / High), which creates a flood of false urgency!

Step 4: Do a Quick Gut-Check & Post the Directory

An engineer spends a few minutes looking over the AI's draft directory to make sure nothing looks obviously wrong (the PDF specifically says: "Don't spend hours making it perfect right now—good enough is fine for the pilot"). Then they post that directory sheet into the cluster.

Step 5: Run the Practice Scan & Look at the Pretty Report

The engineer runs one scan command. It produces two files:

1. vdr-k8s.html — A visual webpage you can open on your computer to click around, filter your findings, and see your new fix-it deadlines.

2. vdr-k8s.json — The raw data file.

What Can't the Practice Scanner Do? (And What Happens Next)

• Practice Scanner Limits: The local practice tool only calculates scores. It isn't where you mark things as "False Alarm" or "Waiting on a Vendor Fix," those workflow buttons live inside TSW. But it should get your system well positioned for when we go live.

• Want a Sneak Peek? If you send your scan file (vdr-k8s.json) to stackArmor, we will load it into our test TSW system and hop on a call to show you exactly how your apps and findings will look in the new dashboard.

• The Timeline:

1. Right Now (Phase 1): Run this local practice pilot and send us your generated directory (vdr-fedramp.yaml), scan file (vdr-k8s.json), and feedback.
    a. Get your team into the mindset of identifying and remediating vulnerabilities in days and weeks not months.
2. Mid-November stackArmor will begin creating CRs in GitLab for review and approval of the uplift to TSW 4.0 and VDR/VER.
3. December 7, 2026: Official go-live of VDR/VER as currently outlined by CISA and FedRAMP.